WORKSHOP HANDOUT

# Decentralized curation

Putting self-interest to work for the public good.

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

## Who judges what matters?

Research relies on judgments about what to read, cite, reuse and reward. This proposal rewards assessment and correction; funding is one application.

## The funding application

1. **Set terms:** purpose, public policy and fixed economic rules.
2. **Nominate:** identify a beneficiary, publish evidence, request a weight and post a deposit. Claims need no prior truth approval.
3. **Judge relevance:** stake-backed, randomly drawn juries seal and reveal scores under the policy.
4. **Appeal:** publicly crowdfund competing scores. An opposed appeal doubles the jury target; payouts depend on distance to the final score.
5. **Curate shares:** publish relative allocation shares. Distribution funding may arrive later.
6. **Fact-check:** anyone may post a bond and fees to challenge false or non-falsifiable claims anytime while active, including during relevance proceedings. An external arbitrator decides. Success costs the nomination its bond and future funding. Previous earnings remain immediately claimable, including during disputes. Fresh nominations remain possible.
7. **Revisit:** new relevance assessments can change future funding.

## Fund curation; distribute later

**Effective weight = the lower of requested weight and curated score.** Normalize eligible weights to shares totalling one; later funding follows them. No positive weights means no allocation. Shares express policy judgments, not measured benefit. See the illustrative NumPy example.

Curation must be funded; the distribution budget can come later. Only new nominations serve holdback; earned funds are immediately claimable.

## Try, read, stay in touch

The room

Published preprint

Mailing list

## Today: experience one layer

Read the policy, score alone, seal, then reveal. This hosted game uses equal seats and points. Its band follows the mean and standard deviation; rewards depend on closeness. At essentially zero spread, distance forfeits switch off.

Workshop simplification: each round with opened scores pays the full base reward, even when those scores all agree.

Use an alias or observe. Revealed scores and standings are visible; adversarial role-play may be assigned. Ask before photographing results. The host wipes session results afterward; they have no automatic expiry.

Keep score proofs private. This game's reporting bounty is absent from the inspected contracts. The game does not run accuracy disputes, jury selection, appeals or a funding stream.

## Example pool policy

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Score the work identified by each nomination. If entries claim the same work, credit that shared work once across them; distinct contributions by the same beneficiary remain eligible.

Docket: Inkscape, Linux, PDF, LaTeX, arXiv, NumPy.

## From experience to evidence

Ask whether the game rewarded evidence use or merely agreement. Neither stake nor agreement proves truth or public benefit. Reliable judgments and collusion resistance remain unproven.

Arrow is a planned precursor experiment at Octant: invited experts score a real docket under a published policy. It assumes honesty, competence and non-collusion; it does not validate the full permissionless system. octant.build

Room: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Join: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/join/

Published preprint, version 1.2.0: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23313625.

Release source · Public mechanism and evidence limits. Later hardening is outside this archived release.

Sponsored by Octant

Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.

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